

Gond art in sheet metal - drawing outlines, perforating, smoothening and polishing

Think Athangudi tiles or reed grass cladding from Tamil Nadu, or elements of Kerala's tharavadu homes or Gujarat havelis.

Imagine also the opportunity for incorporating regional handicrafts across states, in the innumerable new railway stations and airports being planned.

And here's the best news saved for the last. Sibanand says it's not expensive to include bespoke artisanal features in architecture!



Creating tall, sandstone jaali panel,
Krushi Bhavan, Bhubaneswar

The craftspersons here are organised in a dedicated studio to work on architectural projects. They have worked closely with architects to create extraordinary buildings such as the Krushi Bhavan and the Odisha Biotech Park in Bhubaneswar; and recently, the nearby IIT Ranchi.

Sibanand says that other states can replicate the model of Collective Craft, also employing artisanal designs native to the region. In this manner they can nurture and sustain any number of local crafts and provide livelihood to entire artisan communities on a scale they would not otherwise encounter. Imagine beautifully designed landmark buildings that rise in harmony with the local landscape and culture while boosting the local rural economy.











Wrought iron panel in Gond art style. Prototype at IIT Ranchi

For every project, groups of craftspeople are housed at the Collective Craft studio. They live and work here for a continuous few months till their creations are ready to go up.







Happenings in Handmade

A CCI initiative March 2024

Craftsmanship returns to Indian Architecture

Creative crafts were a part of architectural design in India for many, many unbroken centuries, before handmade elements were replaced by the speed and economy but dull uniformity of machine made.

Fortunately, a few young visionary architects are reversing the pattern. At the forefront of the movement is Sibanand Bhol, architect and founder of Collective Craft, Odisha, a collaboration that is formed at the cusp of architectural design and artisanal craftsmanship.

Why only in and around Odisha? For one thing, Sibanand is Odia and his sensibilities are moored here, which made it a good place to establish his brave new venture. For another, it is part of a region rich in a variety of craft traditions. One can draw upon any or all of them without dislocation or disruption to the lives of the respective artisans.

HiH Mar2024 Links
Collective Craft:
https://www.instagram.com/tv/CSe5gb1Japj/?igsh=MTl1NDNkbXFtY292Nw==